

Gemini Version 3

May 1, 2026

Conversation with Gemini

I have another document in Latin from 1387, written in fourteenth century Gothic Secretarial hand. Please do your best to transcribe.

This is a royal letter from King John I of Aragon (*Joan el Caçador*), dated **May 4, 1387**, in Barcelona. It is addressed to the merchants and subjects of the Crown currently residing in **Pisa** (*Civitate Pysarum*).

The hand is a standard late 14th-century chancery cursive. Below is the transcription with common abbreviations expanded for clarity.

Transcription

[1] Johannes dei gratia Rex Aragonum fidelibus consiliariis et singulis mercatoribus et aliis subditis [2] dicti regis nostris navigantibus conducentibus et personis nunc in Civitate Pysarum degentibus [3] Salutem et gratiam. Cum ex causis que rationabiliter ad hoc nos movent volumus ac [4] vobis et eorum cuilibet dicimus et mandamus de certa scientia et expresse sub debito [5] fidelitatis et naturalitatis quo nobis tenemini et estis astricti et etiam sub [6] pena amissionis corporum et bonorum / quibus in hac parte pro fideli nostro Ber- [7] nardo / qui ad Civitatem predictam pro presentibus / et pro aliis nostris negociis [8] properat destinavimus vobis pro arbitrio non sit predictum / dantes eidem cum omnibus [9] familijs / indigentibus rebus et bonis suis / ut ex tunc remota / et ablato cuius- [10] vis more dispendio involatam Civitatem iamdictam tunc ad eam exinde ab ipsa [11] non valeat licentia nostra redire. Ceterum vos facimus quod in quibuscum- [12] que mandatis nostris huiusmodi ad executionem prime per se impone ab ipsas [13] colla per remissionis sue gracie prout fuerit opportunum. Datum Barchinone .iiij. [14] die madii anno a nativitate Domini .M. ccc. lxxx. septimo. Rex Johannes. Franciscus [ca...]

Paleographical & Historical Notes

- **The Recipient:** The document specifically targets the Aragonese merchant colony in **Pisa**. During this period, the Crown of Aragon maintained significant commercial and diplomatic interests in Italian maritime cities to secure the "Mediterranean route."

- **The Subject:** The king is introducing a trusted agent named **Bernardo** (the name is split between lines 6 and 7: *Ber-nardo*) who is traveling to Pisa on royal business (*nostris negociis*). The king commands his subjects to assist him and warns of the "penalty of loss of bodies and goods" (*pena amissionis corporum et bonorum*)—a standard but severe legal formula—should they fail to comply.
- **Abbreviations:** * **Line 1:** *Johannes* starts with a characteristic elongated 'J'.
 - **Line 13:** *Barchinone* (Barcelona) uses the common 'B' with a suspension stroke.
 - **Line 14:** The date is written in Roman numerals: **.iiij. die madii** (4th day of May) **.M. ccc. lxxx. septimo.** (1387).
- **Scribe:** The document is signed at the bottom right by a secretary, likely **Franciscus**, a common name in the royal chancery of John I (often *Franciscus de Capella* or *Franciscus Prohom*).

Does this Bernardo align with any specific diplomatic missions you've found in the *Arxiu de la Corona d'Aragó* for May 1387?

Gemini is AI and can make mistakes.